



GENOF



If a successful conquest is what pumps you up, aim your arrows straight at these hot tips

In *Age of Empires II: Age of Kings*, you take control of one of 13 civilisations that include the Chinese, the Goths, the Britons, and the Vikings among others. You start off with a handful of villagers and expand and manage your economy to a point where you can build a powerful war machine. The strategy, speed, and tactics needed to win make it quite similar to speed chess. *Age of Empires* has a huge fan base and was a tourney favourite at the World Cybergames held in December 2001 in Korea. 

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Defence Tips

An early blow in the feudal stages of the game can put you in a position where you are unable to recover. Here are a few simple tips. If you don't have enough money to make walls, use trees for protection. Keep scouts busy from the early stages of the game—they keep an eye on the resources, the enemy on the map, spots to take advantage of, and the wall. Housing that is spread out and wide will take a longer time to come under attack. Housing spread far out also lets you expand your territory, setting up the infrastructure when you advance to the later stages. Housing can also act like radars, keeping the fog of war at bay. Don't go around building clumps of houses and buildings just because they look pretty. Spread out your buildings and decentralise your base. Your enemy will end up attacking low priority buildings that can act as subterfuge.



Counter Attack

Every civilisation in the *Age of Kings* has a unique unit that you may have no answer for. For example, if a Japanese opponent is messing your happiness with his samurais, a brigade of archers can bring them down easily. Britons have great arching units with better ranges, but have weak paladins. Vikings are better warriors on water, with cheap docks and war ships. It's important to know your weakness and build your support structure around it. The trick is finding the chink in your opponent's armour and then exploiting it.



Activate Cheats

Car Cheat: To get a car that fires bullets during a game, hit [Enter] and type **HOW DO I TURN THIS ON**. The car should appear by your first Town Center. It gives you a cobra car, which has 500 hit points, 10 attack, 10 armour, and 10 range.

Reveal Map: To reveal the map, but not remove the fog of war, hit [Enter] and type **MARCO**. Typing **POLO** removes the fog of war; you can see the territory you have explored but not any activity on it originating out of your units or buildings' line of sight.

Speed Tips

The old adage that time waits for no man holds especially true in the *Age of Kings*. In this game, the faster you build up your civilisation, the more military units you can crank out, and, conversely, the more technology you can research. Hotkeys here is the name of the game—assign the [Ctrl] button and a number to a unit. It helps you plan and command an organised attack. Building can also be faster if you use the keyboard and the mouse simultaneously.

Build a house	Click a villager, then press [B] and the [E]
Build a farm	Click a villager, then press [B] and then [F]
Build a tower	Click a villager, then press [B] and then [T]
Build a building	Click a villager, then press [B] + Hotkey for the building
Build military building	Click a villager, then press [V] + Hotkey for the military building

MRP: Rs 299 · Min Requirements: Pentium 166 MHz, 32 MB of RAM, 200 MB of hard disk space, 4x CD-ROM, Windows 95 or above.